

Franklin County

Adams, Stryker Alexzander

FARMINGTON

I'm an activities and was a graham supporter more of his platforms and I am worried my voice won't be heard and we will get someone who won't value what graham did. I have done many protest in my life and voted often, and have always been a Democrat and being an activist I also have been listening to what folks say.

LGBTQIA+

Amato, Keith M

WILTON

As a delegate, I want to help our party stay grounded in that same honesty — being willing to have hard conversations, hear different points of view, and build consensus rather than division. I believe defeating Susan Collins this November requires exactly that kind of openness: meeting voters where they are, especially those who feel unseen by politics as usual, including people affected by addiction, housing insecurity, or economic hardship. I'll work to register voters, support local volunteers, and speak honestly about my own story where it can help others feel less alone and more willing to get involved. Beyond the election, I want to help keep our grassroots energy sustainable — encouraging new voices, staying open to different perspectives within our party, and making sure the momentum we've built continues to grow through genuine community connection, not just campaign cycles. I'd be grateful for your support and trust as a delegate.

Bailey, Lily

JAY

I have a physical disability and I feel it's important to represent my community in this process. At 21, I am also a young democrat, and I feel like the youth of our party cannot be ignored in such an important process. I'm going to take my experience as the founder of the Saint Joseph's College Disability Awareness Club to help unseat Susan Collins. As an avid disability advocate, I know what this movement means and I believe it's a critical step for our party. I would be both honored and humbled to be part of the change.

Disability, Youth

Barnum, J Jeffrey

NEW VINEYARD

The winning candidate must be judged on character and policy positions. Additionally, they must commit to representing all Maine residents and the people of the US. The winner must remain available to Mainers after election in every possible way. Defending the US Constitution, in both its written and implied language is essential. Defending our democracy shall be a primary responsibility. I will do whatever I am able to insure that candidate's election

Beliveau, Liam

RANGELEY

Troy Jackson is the fighter Maine needs in the U.S. Senate to advocate for working-class families and rural communities. As a fifth-generation logger and Maine Senate President, Jackson understands the economic challenges everyday people face because he has lived them. In the state legislature, Jackson successfully championed lower prescription drug costs, protected union jobs, and expanded healthcare access in rural areas. He knows that a strong economy is built from the bottom up, not the top down. His proven legislative record shows he can deliver real results rather than partisan talking points. Jackson's platform focuses on the issues that matter most to Mainers. He is dedicated to lowering the cost of living, protecting reproductive freedom, and investing in clean energy jobs. His deep roots in northern Maine allow him to unite voters across geographic and political divides, bringing an authentic rural voice to Washington. Voters ready for a senator who challenges corporate interests and stands up for regular people will find that champion in Troy Jackson. He will bring grit, integrity, and real-world experience to the Capitol, ensuring that Maine's working families are never left behind.

Beliveau, Severin

DALLAS PLT

Troy Jackson should be elected to the U.S. Senate because of his lifelong, proven track record of fighting for working-class families and rural communities in Maine. A fifth-generation logger from Allagash, Jackson truly understands the struggles of everyday Mainers. Throughout his tenure in the Maine legislature and as Senate President, Jackson championed vital causes such as lowering prescription drug costs, protecting union jobs, expanding rural healthcare access, and delivering crucial property tax relief. His approach is rooted in the belief that the economy should serve the working class, not just corporate special interests. His grassroots, working-class platform resonates across Maine. Having previously received the endorsement of Sen. Bernie Sanders, Jackson has long been a staunch defender of reproductive freedom, clean energy initiatives, and affordable housing. As a seasoned organizer and labor advocate, he is uniquely positioned to bridge the gap between rural, inland areas and the state's coastal hubs. Furthermore, Jackson possesses the resilience and determination needed to unseat incumbent Senator Susan Collins. His deep familiarity with the

everyday economic realities facing Mainers allows him to craft policies that directly benefit the people rather than out-of-touch political insiders. By sending Jackson to Washington, voters will gain an authentic, unapologetic voice who will relentlessly push for policies like Medicare for All and robust labor protections.

Bobrow, Adam

FARMINGTON

I am an engaged Democrat with a record of commitment to the party. I was a delegate to this year's convention. In March, I joined our county chair to observe the recount of Farmington's school board election. Before the primary, I hosted a meet and greet for one of our CD-2 candidates in my home. During the Obama Administration I served at the Commerce Department and the White House, so I understand the policy stakes of choosing the right candidate through this process. Defeating Susan Collins is essential. I will work tirelessly to get our nominee elected in November. As I did during the primary, I will organize canvasses from my home and knock doors to activate voters and persuade those we need in competitive Franklin county to vote for Democrats. I will volunteer my voter protection experience to be certain every vote is counted and no voters are intimidated. Harnessing the grass roots energy of Graham's campaign will ensure victory in the fall. Without him in the race, Maine Democrats can advance the desire for bold policy change only by ensuring that the people he reached, many of them unenrolled voters, feel heard. As a lifelong Democrat, I supported Graham's campaign because he presented a bold policy platform and communicated how to enact it, reaching people who ordinarily do not vote for Democrats. In my role as delegate, I will choose a candidate who can tap into that grass roots energy to win in November.

Canales, Caleb

WILTON

I want to serve as a delegate of the Nominating Convention so that I can provide support towards the Democratic Party of Maine. I plan on voting for Troy Jackson in order to defeat Susan Collins. A person like Susan Collins is unfit for Maine and only cares about herself and public appearance.

Canales, Marco

WILTON

I would like to be a delegate because I feel that I would be able to represent my community of Wilton, Maine as well as a Hispanic American and as a family man as well. I want to be proud to represent our country. It starts with all of us first at this level. I want to be proud of our country once again.

Carey, Michele J

TEMPLE

Over the past 6 months i have stepped up to become more involved and aware regarding this year's midterm elections. There are many candidates stepping forward to run for this Senate nomination for the Maine Dems, and I have paid very close attention to their positions and platforms. I will give equal attention to the ideals and values of the lesser known candidates, to insure my decision is one made confidently & compassionately.

Cayer, Deborah J

CHESTERVILLE

I have been working hard for the candidate to defeat Senator Collins and take back the senate I want to be involved to ensure that whoever our candidate is can win. I will be canvassing, writing postcards and working with the Franklin county democrats as well as the Western Kennebec County Indivisibles. I will be working with Western Mountain Third Act to register voters.

Chamberlain, Donna

PHILLIPS

“You can never get comfortable. Democracy and freedom need to be fought for in every generation.” Jasmine Crocket The results of this midterm election may make the difference between starting to rebuild the institutions of our democratic republic and descending further into the abyss of fascist dictatorship. Defeating Collins is critical. It is also critical that we elect a democratic senator with the values we share and the legislative abilities to make them count on the national level. In the past I have been a candidate for the Maine House of Representatives, served as treasurer or campaign manager for multiple campaigns, served on town committees, served as a Franklin county delegate to the state committee, and knocked on enough doors to rival a wood pecker. This is the fight of our lives. Please vote for me to represent you at the nominating convention. See you on the campaign trail! Donna Chamberlain

Dardis, Edward

CARRABASSETT VALLEY

Both my wife and I supported Graham Platner in his bid for Maine’s senate seat. We were thrilled by his decisive victory in the June primaries and felt that the energy, voice, and hope he brought to the campaign would lead to victory over Sen Collins. We contributed to his campaign and I served as a delegate to the Maine Democratic Party Convention in May 2026. During the convention I had the opportunity to meet with all of the candidates for Governor and discuss with them their ideas and positions on the issues. These candidates except Hannah Pingree, have declared their candidacy to

run against Collins. While I have not made up my mind as to who should be selected, I am looking for a “winner” with the best charisma or other attributes and the communications skills necessary to defeat the incumbent. I believe my recent experience at the May convention will be very helpful in selecting a new candidate who can pick up the momentum and assemble a winning campaign.

Davis, Susan S

KINGFIELD

As an active Franklin County Dem., I would like to have my vote for a candidate count at this stage. I will help with doors under Vicki Cohen's guidance. I hope to volunteer at the County Delegate Nominating Meeting. Wayne and Vicki are my guides.

Doiron, Trevor Alex

JAY

As a 27-year-old candidate for the Maine House of Representatives, I believe younger Democrats deserve a meaningful voice in shaping the future of our party. My generation will live with the decisions made today, and it is important that we have a seat at the table. I am also seeking to serve as a delegate because I have a direct stake in electing candidates who will strengthen our party at every level. As someone running in a competitive legislative race, I understand the importance of having a nominee who can energize voters, build strong coalitions, and help Democratic candidates succeed across Maine. I would approach this responsibility thoughtfully, listening to Democrats from across the state while keeping in mind the needs of communities like mine in rural western Maine. It would be an honor to represent my district and help select a nominee who reflects our values and gives Democrats the best opportunity to win in November.

Dunham, William H Jr

CHESTERVILLE

I am a decade long active member of the Franklin County Democrats and have done a lot of canvassing , postcards and phoning, as Vicky Cohen can attest. Collins must be defeated and I will do all I can, along with my wife, Deborah Cayer, to make that happen. I also work with Third Act Indivisible of Farmington and Mt. Vernon and with Bob Sullbarger for State Senate.

Garrett, Austin Mathew

FARMINGTON

As the son a 100% disabled veteran, a UMF alumnus, a former educator, non-profit administrator, and OADS community case manager I have a deep understanding of the issues present in the lives of those in Franklin County and all of Maine. I have seen how Republican administrations of the last 50

years and their policy has directly destroyed the value of our dollar, the integrity of our political system, and challenged our way of life. Nothing is more critical to me than rejecting the systematic corruption of the elite class and the politics that protect their greed. Maine must ensure the candidate we elect can continue this movement as a champion of the working class, defeat Susan Collins, and deliver the senate majority. I thank you for your honest consideration, Austin M. Garrett

LGBTQIA+, Youth

Gilbert, Lauren

WILTON

A lifelong Democrat in western Maine, I believe I can make a difference in November if selected as a delegate. The Town of Wilton in Franklin County, where I live, leans Republican, but I believe we can turn it blue. If selected, I will reach out to people to get their perspectives on different candidates, engaging with people outside local post offices and hosting events at my home in downtown Wilton. I will coordinate with Western Maine's Third Act, which meets regularly in Farmington. After a candidate is selected, I will work to ensure their election in November, including recruiting volunteers, organizing phone banks, canvassing, and ballot curing. I am a retired law professor, ACLU member, and participant in several No Kings protests. Born in Connecticut, my ties to Maine go back generations. My grandfather co-founded Camp Owatonna in Harrison in the mid-1950s. My family spent summers here, and my aunt and uncle moved to Cumberland Foreside in 1974. They now live in Bridgton. I moved to Florida to pursue a teaching career. There, I was active in the Democratic Party, doing election monitoring, help lines, and ballot curing. A law professor in Florida for 22 years, I owned a small cottage in Bridgton, Maine. I left Florida in January 2025, as the Trump reign began, and moved here in March 2025. I hope to spend my life here and to use my political and legal skills to support Maine Dems and build on the grassroots momentum it has achieved.

Immigrant/New Mainer

Hall, Morgen

INDUSTRY

Hello. I would like to become a delegate because I think I represent several important demographics in Maine and am deeply invested and committed to the fight to overturn this Senate seat. I'm a 35 year old mother of two who spent almost a decade teaching high school and am now a youth minister/music teacher/ farmer in rural (Red) Maine. I was initially very excited about Platners' campaign because of his progressive platform and grassroots appeal so am hoping the candidate who will run against Collins will be able to keep this fire alive in the Democratic party and many more in Maine. Whoever the candidate is needs people like me on the ground engaging people - especially in a place like Industry! I'm feeling more politically engaged than ever in my life and love that this process is making space for folks like me to get more involved. I'm active in work on the ground here in Franklin county from resistance singing to no kings to signage and discussions with scowling but curious neighbors. I appreciate the consideration and am excited to help with the work ahead.

Haywood, Erica Christie

FARMINGTON

I met and reported on several candidates between November and this spring, including Graham Platner. I was inspired by his platform, yet also have a deep, abiding respect for our governor and fellow Farmington resident, Janet Mills. I have been a liberal thinker all my life and helped caucus for Sanders ten years ago now, counting votes alongside Janet at UMF in 2016. I would be honored to be chosen as a delegate for Franklin County because not only do I know its people and this community very well, I am its everyman (everywoman). I am inspired to rally behind and help elect the candidate whom we will rise up to defeat Susan Collins in November.

Johnson, Sarah Lovering

SANDY RIVER PLT

Having watched the destruction of the federal government since the start of the second Trump administration, it is clear to me that turning the Senate and the House is the only way for the American experiment to survive. I am convinced that Maine's US Senate election is key to turning the Senate from red to blue, and I would be honored to be one of Franklin County's delegates. Nothing is more critical to Maine and the country's future than nominating a Democrat who is ethically beyond reproach, one with specific plans for national rebuilding who is willing to run a vigorous campaign in a foreshortened season. I am eager to help find and vet that candidate, and help mobilize Franklin County voters to get him or her elected. Listening carefully to objections, as well as acknowledging things that we can do better, are keys to any successful campaign; and we will need to listen to all voters, in particular, those who are mourning Platner and will be resentful of a different candidate. My husband and I are already writing 200 postcards to Maine voters; in addition, I will phone, text, and drive other campaign helpers; and I will speak with voters, so that we can defeat Senator Collins in November.

Masterman, Adam

KINGFIELD

I'm a progressive who wants to see real change in Washington and America; things like universal healthcare and childcare, free higher education, and an end to military imperialism. I supported Platner because of his platform, and I want us to choose a candidate who can also articulate the message that mobilized so many of my fellow Mainers. I've had many conversations with friends and neighbors, and witnessed the galvanizing power of a candidate who spoke directly to issues that politicians rarely address. Working people are getting the short end of the stick, precisely because the ultra-wealthy are rigging the system to claim more and more wealth. People know this; they see it happening and feel life getting more difficult with each passing year. To have finally heard this, bluntly and directly, from a candidate with a real shot at winning, was what brought so much energy and engagement to our primary. I think a genuine policy alternative to what the GOP is offering is the only path to building

grassroots power and defeating the authoritarians in power, and I want to help select an individual who can represent the ideas that gave us this momentum in the first place. I plan to listen to who can articulate those ideals clearly, unequivocally, and in a way that demonstrates understanding. I genuinely believe that the only way we can defeat Collins is to capitalize on the momentum Platner initiated, and let people vote for those policy priorities attached to a worthy representative.

Matthias, Weeza

KINGFIELD

I have been fairly active in politics most of my life. Just moved to Kingfield a year ago & this is

McGrane, Gary T

JAY

I wish to participate in the process because we need to select a person with a progressive platform.

BIPOC

Neithercutt, Becky

FARMINGTON

I am seeking to be a delegate because I am at a breaking point with the current direction of the Democratic Party. For too long, the party has prioritized winning over the duty of serving the people. The decision to elevate candidates like Graham Platner, which was driven by tactical optics rather than a genuine commitment to our community, was a profound failure and it is one that I refuse to overlook. I am running because I want to force the party to answer a simple, fundamental question: Are we Democrats, or are we just another arm of the status quo? We have drifted from our foundational compass. We have remained silent while wealth has purchased our elections, while our civil rights, healthcare, and economic future have been eroded, and while the rule of law has been treated as an inconvenience. If this party expects to earn the support of the people and the 'everyday' voters who feel left behind by both parties it must stop catering to billionaires and start championing the basic needs of our citizens. I am not here to flatter or maintain the status quo. I am here to demand a return to our principles. My participation is a fight for the future of this party; if the Democratic Party cannot or will not return to its core mission of serving the people, then it has lost its purpose entirely. I am running to ensure that if there is still a soul left in this party,

Olmstead, Dion R

NEW SHARON

I would like to be part of this process. It is very important that we all work together to find a candidate that represents well the momentum we have built. As a life long, working class rural democrat, I believe it is important that we are represented and that my people feel included in the democrat party. I am happy to help in any way possible, leading up to the election

Olmstead, Maxwell

NEW SHARON

I have firmly believed in Troy's message from the beginning of his campaign for governor. I'd like to serve as a delegate to contribute as much as possible to the campaign, and getting Susan Collins out of office. In the coming months I would be willing to canvass voters, phone bank, and recruit volunteers. I'm really excited about Troy's campaign and want to get involved as much as possible!

Osborne, Peter Alan

JAY

Firstly, I am unable to participate in the County nominating meeting, as I have a previous commitment and the meetings were scheduled with short notice. Secondly, I am a long-time supporter and advocate for the progressive policies championed by those who voted for Platner in the primary election and am committed to selecting a nominee whose policy goals are aligned with their wishes. That's my primary commitment because over 150,000 Mainers strongly expressed their support for these policies in the June primary. I will fight to ensure that the 601 un-democratically selected delegates who will choose the nominee align with the will of the people who already made their voices heard. Thirdly, once that decision is made, my focus will be on defeating Susan Collins and doing all within my power to elect a Democratic senator to represent Maine. This will include donating personal funds to support the campaign and encouraging those in my social circles to vote and support the candidate. Finally, the last prompt for this statement is to describe how I'll help the party to "continue to build on the grassroots momentum." I don't believe the party has built on grassroots momentum in how it's handled this process or Platner's candidacy. I support the need for him to have stepped down, but I am appalled at the animosity the state party has demonstrated toward his campaign and supporters. That IS the party's grassroots momentum. I strongly encourage the state party to harness that energy, not alienate it.

Ouellette, Jennifer Lynn Lynn

JAY

I would like to serve as a delegate at the Nominating Convention because I want to have a voice in representing the diverse population of Maine where I have lived for 71 years. I will work to defeat Senator Collins in the same way I always work with my Democratic party - through active involvement. I am secretary of my municipal committee, treasurer of my county committee, past chair of my county committee, active participant on various sub-committees and activities. Maine is a perfect example of a state where grassroots momentum is essential, because our resources are limited compared to more populous states. Grassroots efforts thrive when everyone lifts their load and carries on. That is my practice now and my intention is that it will continue to be.

Peck, Susan G

CARRABASSETT VALLEY

Our priority should be to defeat Susan Collins, and I believe we can do that with a strong and respected candidate. I would be willing and able to attend the convention on July 25, and I have done canvassing, phone banking and postcard writing in several election cycles in Maine, primarily for Jared Golden and the presidential candidates, but also for other candidates. I have lived in Maine for 50 years, as a registered Democrat, with protection of civil rights and social safety net programs my primary concerns. I have served on and chaired the ACLU of Maine Board of Directors, and the CAP Agency in Cumberland County (formerly PROP). I am a retired attorney, wife, mother of three adult daughters, and grandparent to five young children. I believe Shenna Bellows would be an excellent Senator, and I also am confident that we have other candidates I can support if that is the will of the people. What would I do to elect a new senator? Everything I can!

Prior, Roderick

FARMINGTON

I care deeply about getting a competent Democratic senator in place of Susan Collins, who represents the Maine people and not Donald Trump and MAGA

Riggs, Shaun David

FARMINGTON

The importance of this seat cannot be overstated. I am not just concerned with the number 51, but excited about what that number means. With control of both chambers, we won't have to wait for the next administration to start correcting the errors of the current one. I want to be a part of the movement to seize this opportunity, and take seriously the job of a delegate. I hope to be chosen as one. Thank you.

Robinson, Yvette E

FARMINGTON

I believe Susan Collins can be defeated. As a lifelong Democrat, I am eager to work with fellow delegates to identify and elect the best candidate for Maine. I will carefully weigh the messaging, experience and character of each candidate while respectfully considering the will of the voters in our most recent election. It would be an honor to represent my community, Franklin County, in this important task.

Rosenwald, John

FARMINGTON

I have been honored to serve as a member of the Franklin County Democratic Party for more than twenty years: as Vice-Chair of the County Party, as a regular member of the Maine State Platform Committee, and as a Representative to the Maine State Democratic Party Convention. I wish to have a chance this year to represent this county at the State Nominating Convention, to observe first hand the candidates seeking nomination as our state candidate for election to the United States Senate. I currently have not made an explicit decision to vote for any one of the current candidates, wishing to see and hear them present in person the reasons why they should become our official candidate.

Shagin, Paula

PHILLIPS

As a resident of a rural county, I know taking time to engage in state and national politics is hard to come by, even as I recognize that it is absolutely vital to do so. I want to see inclusive, socially conscious, ethical candidates create real change that improves the lives of everyday Mainers. I cannot leave my land to go to protests and meetings every week, but I can attend the convention on July 25th and want to serve my neighbors and communities to the best of my ability. I will listen carefully and choose wisely.

Shifrin, Brett Morgan

WELD

I want to be a delegate because I believe it is essential that our candidate advocate for individual rights, social programs that promote educational opportunities, transparency in government, and stop the Trump administration's destruction of American institutions, programs and ideals.

Shippee, Laurel

WILTON

I am committed to democracy and the rule of law. Always have been. Always will be. I am active and support the Democratic agenda. We have to defeat Collins.

Small, Ryan

JAY

I wish to attend the Nominating Convention in order to preserve the spirit of voters decisions within my county at the primary. It is unfortunate that this process has to take place but given the circumstances I believe it is important that the will of the voters in my county is respected and that this Convention is as democratic as possible. It would be a failure of the democratic process if this convention was to be or appear to be a rubber stamp committee for the national democrats. For this reason I will be voting for Troy Jackson. I am a respected labor leader in the state and county and believe I am the most trusted individual to carry your votes.

Smith, Anne Margaret Margaret

STRONG

What we want to avoid at all costs is more drama and any attempt to drive a wedge between us. My job as a delegate would be to thoughtfully consider all the candidates and distinguish between the media hype and their true character, experience and abilities. I'm the chair of our regional caucus and was on the Platform Committee for a couple of years. I will be hosting a morale boosting gathering at our house in August for our regional caucus, which will be attended by a couple of local candidates for office, and I will be out canvassing this summer to defeat Susan Collins.

Sonnthal, Susan

RANGELEY

The selection of a person to represent the values and needs of the people of the state of Maine in the UNITED STATES SENATE is critical. The country is in crisis because of the policies and overreach being enacted by the current administration. Senator Collins is responsible for facilitating the passage and enactment of these policies. I want to do as much as possible to see that Mrs Collins can no longer ignore the needs of all Mainers. I will be available to drive the selected candidate, to send out postcards and anything else within my power to find and support an honorable candidate with the intention to work for healthcare, childcare, housing, Native Americans, education and workers who is truly able to beat Mrs Collins.

Immigrant/New Mainer

Spencer-Gardner, Nicole

NEW SHARON

I will support Troy Jackson if I am a delegate. I am a disabled 23 year old whose rights were taken away as soon as I was born. I want to help people like me who are born with birth defects, who are LGBTQ+, people who are working class, and who are born with a uterus. With these in mind I want to help support Troy Jackson, it would be essential to me to be apart of something big. Troy Jackson truly believes in all the things that he says and does. He's exactly what we the people are looking for when we say we need affordable healthcare, equal rights, and women protection. I will do whatever is needed to help support the community, and to help defeat Susan Collin's

LGBTQIA+, Disability, Youth

Stein, Peter

SANDY RIVER PLT

I am a 67 year-old scientist/engineer with a PhD from MIT and the Woods Hole Oceanographic Institution. I have been witness to so many amazing things in my life. Wife, kids, grandkids, and the development of technology that now allows us to create a sustainable and peaceful planet. But I have also watched our society crumble due to greed, corruption, counterproductive policies, and a total disregard for the Constitution. It breaks my heart. I am very well versed and actively involved in state, national, and world politics. I am a student of history and believe we are at a critical juncture. We must get control of the Senate and the House, and then the Presidency, to stop the worsening of human suffering. I want to ensure we nominate a candidate for Senate that is absolutely the best one to defeat Susan Collins. I believe you have come up with a process that is optimally democratic given the time constraints, respects the will of the voters, and will lead to the best candidate. It would be an honor to be selected as a delegate and to be a part of this process.

Williams, Greg J

FARMINGTON

I want to be a delegate to be part of this unique selection process. My goal is ultimately to be able to promote a candidate who generates the same passion we saw in the candidacy of Graham Platner and who demonstrates leadership qualities to move us effectively beyond the subterfuge of Susan Collins. I'm committed to listening to each candidate, talking with other delegates and helping to identify the person most capable of tackling the local/state/national issues of housing, the cost of living, the healthcare system and constitutional freedoms. I will get behind a person who can walk that fine line of being both articulate and optimistic and relentlessly calculating and tenacious; qualities much needed to overcome the largesse and political machinery behind Collins. I want us to get behind a candidate who is thoroughly vetted and ready to jump in with total commitment and courage - the day after the Nominating Convention. I'm ready to do all I can to help in that process.

fowler, Fenwick L

FARMINGTON

My name is Fen Fowler. I have had the pleasure of living and working in FranklinCounty for over 50 years. I retired in 2015 after working 40 years for Western Maine Community Action-an organization dedicated to helping people work their way out of poverty. I became very politically active after retirement when the Franklin County Government began cutting community and economic development programs amounting to over \$174,000 from their budget. This impacted 9 local non profits and community service agencies helping our most needy. I organized communities and individuals to advocate across the county to restore funding .This advocacy resulted in funding being restored in 2023. I ran for a seat as Franklin County Commissioner in 2024 and was elected. The Democratic June primary attracted 7700 citizens in Franklin County to vote. An estimated 2000 were unenrolled citizens that were passionate for new leadership. That leadership represented a candidate that believed in medicare for all, taxing billionaires, ending money in politics and stopping supporting war around the globe. He believed in investing in climate change and holding our President accountable .Those unenrolled citizens that came out and voted for him are not represented in our process of selection. They are critical to our success to unseat Susan Collins . I am dedicated to reaching out to those citizens through the canvassing process to hear what they think and feed that back to our successful candidate. I look forward to hearing from and helping to decide who that next candidate is.